The Binding of the Agent: Floors and themes

All floor themes in the game, what each one looks and sounds like, and what (if anything) changes in gameplay.

How floors work

Cycle. There are 11 floor themes. Floor *n* uses theme *(n − 1) mod 11*, so the list repeats forever: floor 12 is The Backlog again, floor 14 is Forgotten Branches again, and so on. Repeated floors get a roman numeral on the floor card ("The Backlog II").

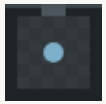
Depth vs. theme. Difficulty follows the **depth** (floor number), never the theme: enemy unlocks, room budgets, HP scaling and boss pools all go by depth. The theme decides the look, the music, the breakable objects and a few theme-specific extras (marked *Gameplay* below).

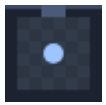
What a theme controls (`B.FLOOR_THEMES` in `src/data/palette.js`, names in `B.TEXT.FLOORS` in `src/data/text.js`):

- **Colours:** floor checkerboard, walls, doors, an accent colour (floor card, HUD floor name, minimap frame), a soft light in the room centre and the vignette tint.
- **Floor pattern** and **decor** (background details baked into the room), optionally **wall decor** and an animated **ambient** layer.
- **Breakable objects:** which kinds appear, in how many combat rooms, and how many per room.
- **Music:** root note, scale, tempo and lead instrument of the procedural chiptune loop.
- **Tile sprites (optional):** a theme can swap the look of rocks, blocks or spikes (`tiles`); Sandbox Borders uses this for sandstone boulders and border fences.
- *Gameplay (optional):* map shape (`gen`), cacti (`cacti`), themed enemies and bosses (`themes` / `themeOnly`), extra quips and epitaphs.

Things that look **the same on every floor**: pits and spikes, doors and the special rooms (treasure, shop, boss, secret); rocks and blocks too, except on Sandbox Borders.

Overview

	#	Floor	Pattern	Decor	Breakables	Music	Extras
	1	**The Backlog** `backlog`	Wooden planks	Sticky notes and paper scraps	Crates	D dorian, 104 bpm, square	—
	2	**Legacy Codebase** `legacy`	Irregular stone slabs	Cobwebs in corners	Crates	A minor, 92 bpm, triangle	—
	3	**Forgotten Branches** `branches`	Moss, soil and grass	Roots drawn like a `git log --graph`	Bushes	G dorian, 98 bpm, triangle, bird calls	Ivy, fireflies, branchier maps, own enemy family and boss

	#	Floor	Pattern	Decor	Breakables	Music	Extras
	4	**Dependency Hell** `dephell`	Square tiles	Glowing cracks and embers	Packages, cartons	B phrygian, 128 bpm, sawtooth	—
	5	**Production** `production`	Checker plate with rivets	Hazard stripes at doors, cables	Packages, cartons	A harmonic minor, 138 bpm, square	—
	6	**Sandbox Borders** `sandbox`	Rippled sand	Bleached bones, pebbles, dry grass	Sandcastles	D phrygian, 100 bpm, triangle	Cacti (solid, prick), border fences, sandstone, tumbleweeds, own enemy family
	7	**The Training Data** `training`	Graph paper	Scattered characters (`0 1 {} lol tl;dr nan`)	Cartons, crates	E major, 116 bpm, triangle	—
	8	**The Latent Space** `latent`	Dot grid	Stars and a constellation	Bushes, packages	C lydian, 96 bpm, sine	—
	9	**Undefined Behavior** `undefined`	Square tiles	Shifted colour stripes (glitches)	All four kinds	B♭ locrian, 144 bpm, square	—
	10	**/dev/null** `devnull`	Dot grid	Almost nothing: a few lost bits	Crates, packages	G minor, 80 bpm, triangle	—
	11	**The Context Limit** `context`	Square tiles	Fading fragments of earlier context	All four kinds	C♯ mixolydian, 108 bpm, square	—

The swatch is a tiny room in the theme's colours: wall, floor checkerboard, door (top) and accent (centre dot).

Colour coverage

Almost all floors are **dark**: the floors sit at low brightness so that sprites, pickups and enemy shots stand out. Sandbox Borders is the one mid-bright floor; its sand is muted on purpose so yellow and amber shots stay readable. By hue:

- **Browns / warm:** The Backlog (brown), Dependency Hell (rust with orange embers), Production (grey with red walls).
- **Sand / yellow:** Sandbox Borders (dusky sand, sun-yellow accent).
- **Greens:** Forgotten Branches (forest green), The Training Data (muted green).
- **Blues / violets:** Legacy Codebase (blue-grey), The Latent Space (indigo), The Context Limit (pale fog blue).

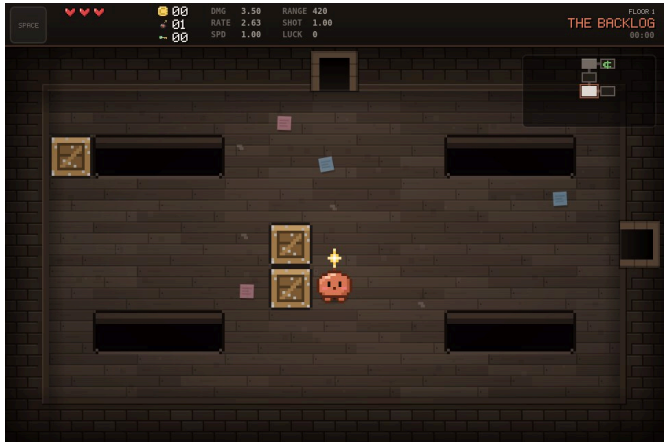
- **Other:** Undefined Behavior (magenta-purple), /dev/null (near black).

Gaps: nothing cyan or teal, and nothing truly bright (white, snow, light stone). Several enemies fire yellow or amber shots, so check contrast with screenshots before settling on a bright palette.

The floors

1. The Backlog

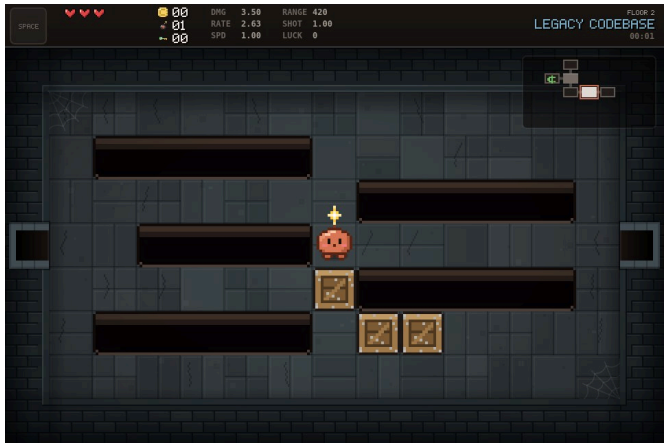
Where tickets go to die.



- **Look:** warm cardboard brown; horizontal wooden planks with staggered joints; forgotten sticky notes (yellow, pink, blue, green) and paper scraps on the floor. Accent: coral `#d97757` (the avatar's colour).
- **Breakables:** crates in 60 % of combat rooms, up to 3 per room.
- **Music:** D dorian, 104 bpm, square lead.

2. Legacy Codebase

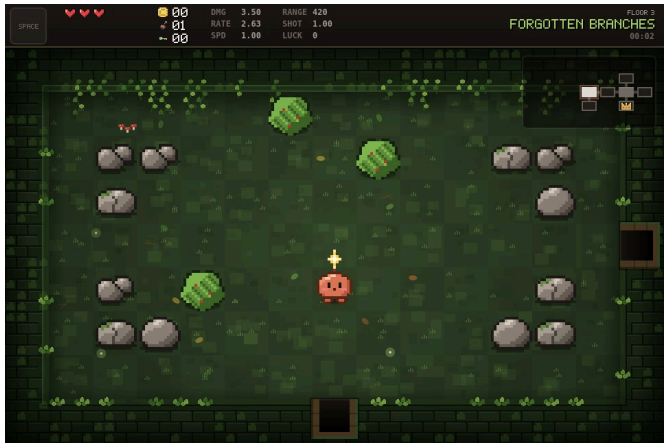
Written by someone who left in 2009.



- **Look:** dusty blue-grey; old, irregular stone slabs (1, 2 or 4 per tile); cobwebs in the inner corners. Accent: steel blue `#7fb0c9`.
- **Breakables:** crates in 65 % of combat rooms, up to 3 per room.
- **Music:** A minor, 92 bpm, triangle lead.

3. Forgotten Branches

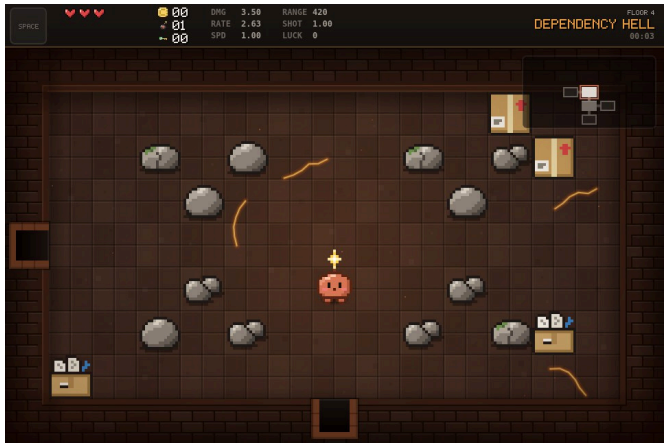
It is probably for the best that these never got merged.



- **Look:** forest floor of moss cushions, soil patches and grass blades instead of joints. Roots on the floor are a little `git log --graph`: a trunk with commit dots and one or two branches that split off and never merge back. Ivy hangs from the walls and fireflies drift through the room. Accent: leaf green `#a6d36b`.
- **Breakables:** bushes in 80 % of combat rooms, up to 4 per room.
- **Music:** G dorian, 98 bpm, triangle lead, with an occasional bird call (never during the boss fight).
- **Gameplay, maps:** branchier, with at least 7 dead ends per floor instead of 3 (`gen.minDeadEnds`).
- **Gameplay, enemies:** an own family found only here: Stale Branch, Detached HEAD, Cherry-Pick and the Orphan Commit (see the enemies list). They share a woody look, leaf effects and wood-knock sounds.
- **Gameplay, boss:** the Octopus Merge, about 52 % on floor 3 and 41 % on floors 14, 25, … on a first visit.
- **Extra text:** room-clear quips ("Branch deleted", "Stale for 847 days", "Rebased onto nothing", …) and epitaphs ("Died on a branch nobody remembers.", …) mixed into the general lists.

4. Dependency Hell

node_modules now has its own gravitational field.



- **Look:** rusty dark brown; square tiles with bevelled edges; glowing cracks and ember dots. The strongest light of all floors (orange). Accent: amber `#f0a03c`.
- **Breakables:** packages and cartons in 70 % of combat rooms, up to 4 per room.
- **Music:** B phrygian, 128 bpm, sawtooth lead.

5. Production

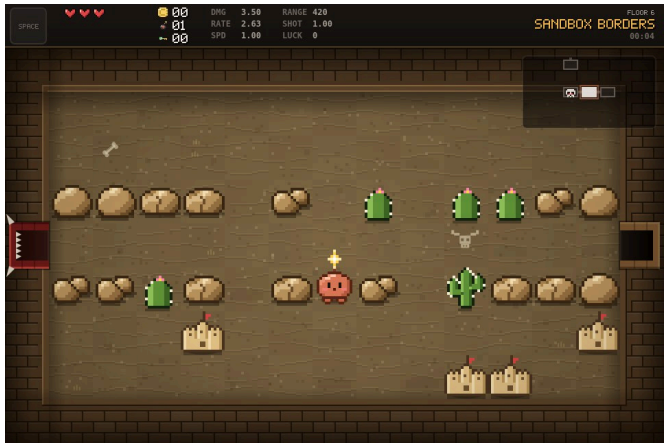
Don't touch anything. Especially on a Friday.



- **Look:** industrial grey checker plate with diagonal studs and riveted seams; dark red walls; yellow-black hazard stripes in front of the doors and cables across the floor. Accent: signal red `#e05a4f`.
- **Breakables:** packages and cartons in 70 % of combat rooms, up to 4 per room.
- **Music:** A harmonic minor, 138 bpm, square lead.

6. Sandbox Borders

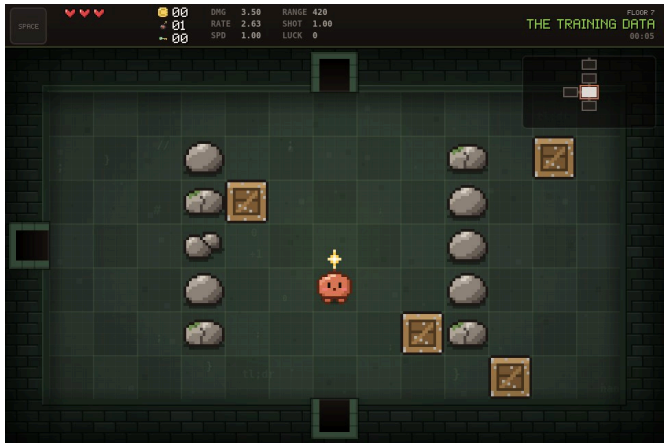
Nobody mentioned the cacti. Or the lack of water.



- **Look:** the edge of the sandbox: dusky, rippled sand (muted, so yellow and amber shots stay readable), sandstone walls, bleached bones in the sand (horned skulls, ribcages, single bones), pebbles and dry grass. Now and then a tumbleweed rolls across the room. Accent: sun yellow `#f2b84b`.
- **Obstacles:** rocks become sandstone boulders, and indestructible blocks become the border itself: chain-link fences with barbed wire where blocks line up, striped concrete barriers where they stand alone.
- **Gameplay, cacti:** half of the rocks in combat rooms are cacti instead. They are solid like rocks but prick you on contact (half a heart and a push back); bombs blow them up. Never right in front of a door.
- **Gameplay, enemies:** an own family found only here, the Spinlock (a coiled desert snake that lunges) and the Rootkit (burrows under the sand and pops up next to you). Deprecation Warnings are 2.5× as common, and Hallucinations twice as likely (mirages).
- **Breakables:** sandcastles in 75 % of combat rooms, up to 4 per room; when damaged, a tower collapses.
- **Music:** D phrygian, 100 bpm, triangle lead.
- **Extra text:** room-clear quips ("Permission denied", "Sandbox violation logged", "No water found", …) and epitaphs ("Escaped the sandbox. Not the cactus.", …).

7. The Training Data

It's mostly forum arguments.



- **Look:** muted green graph paper (fine lines every 16 px, stronger every 64 px); scattered characters from the "training data": `0`, `1`, `{`, `}`, `;`, `+1`, `lol`, `?!`, `tl;dr`, `nan`, … Accent: lime `#8bc34a`.
- **Breakables:** cartons and crates in 70 % of combat rooms, up to 4 per room.
- **Music:** E major, 116 bpm, triangle lead.

8. The Latent Space

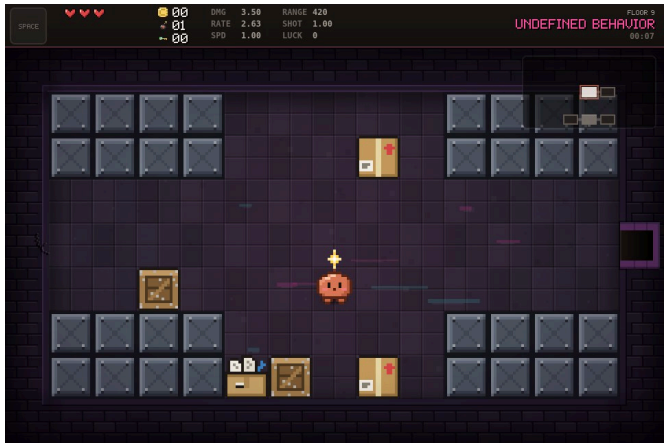
Here be embeddings.



- **Look:** deep indigo with a dot grid; stars (embeddings) and one constellation per room. Accent: lavender `#a78bfa`.
- **Breakables:** bushes and packages in 75 % of combat rooms, up to 4 per room.
- **Music:** C lydian, 96 bpm, sine lead.

9. Undefined Behavior

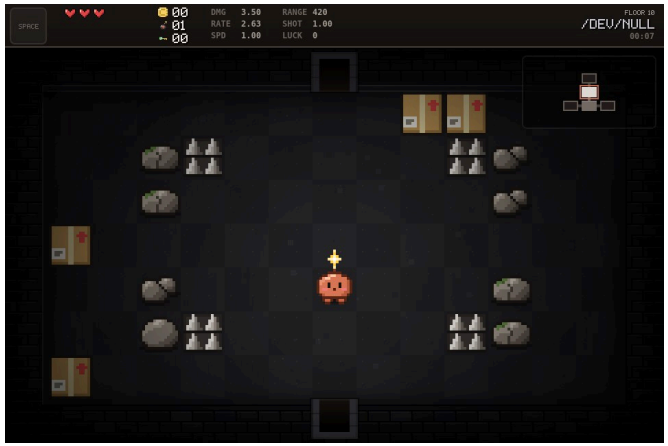
Anything can happen. Mostly bad things.



- **Look:** dark purple tiles with shifted magenta and turquoise stripes, like rendering glitches. Accent: hot pink `#ff4fa3`.
- **Breakables:** all four kinds (crates, bushes, packages, cartons) in 80 % of combat rooms, up to 5 per room.
- **Music:** B♭ locrian, 144 bpm, square lead (the fastest loop).

10. /dev/null

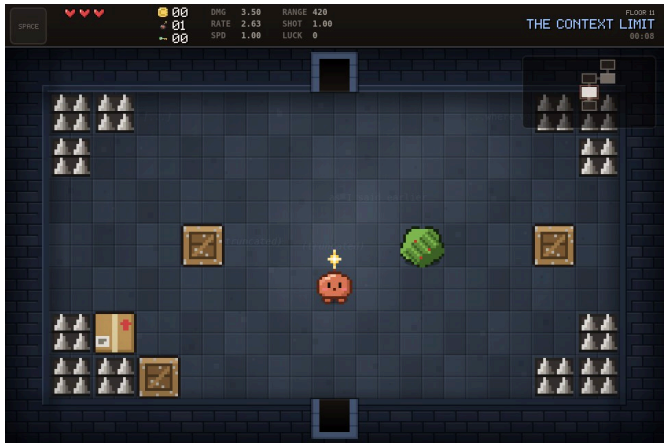
Everything you send here is gone. Including you.



- **Look:** almost black and monochrome; a faint dot grid and almost nothing else, just a few lost bits. Accent: pale grey `#d0d0d8`.
- **Breakables:** crates and packages in 75 % of combat rooms, up to 5 per room.
- **Music:** G minor, 80 bpm, triangle lead (the slowest loop).

11. The Context Limit

You've been here before. You don't remember.



- **Look:** pale fog blue tiles with soft fog patches; faint, half-faded fragments of earlier context on the floor ("[...]", " (truncated)", "as I said earlier", "[context compacted]", ...). Accent: light blue `#9ec5ff`.
- **Breakables:** all four kinds in 80 % of combat rooms, up to 5 per room.
- **Music:** C♯ mixolydian, 108 bpm, square lead.

Adding a floor

The step-by-step recipe is in AGENTS.md (§5, "Add a floor"). In short: add an entry at the same position in `B.TEXT.FLOORS` and `B.FLOOR_THEMES`; new patterns, decor, wall decor or ambient layers need a case in `src/render/renderer.js`. Inserting a floor in the middle shifts every later floor down by one and changes the cycle length, so themed content (like Forgotten Branches) repeats on different floor numbers afterwards. Then run `node tools/export-floors.js` and add the new floor to this document.